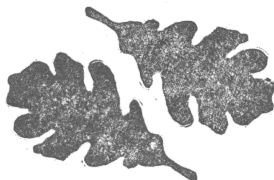


The Wedding
of
Claire Haldeman & Eli Baum

Saturday, September 19, 2026
4:00 p.m.

*203 Upham Street
Melrose, Massachusetts*



Prelude

Abide with Me

Thelonious Monk

Processional

Chisa

Abdullah Ibrahim

John and Mary

Jaco Pastorius



WELCOME

The Rev. Brett R. Johnson

Declaration of Consent

The couple affirms their intention to marry.

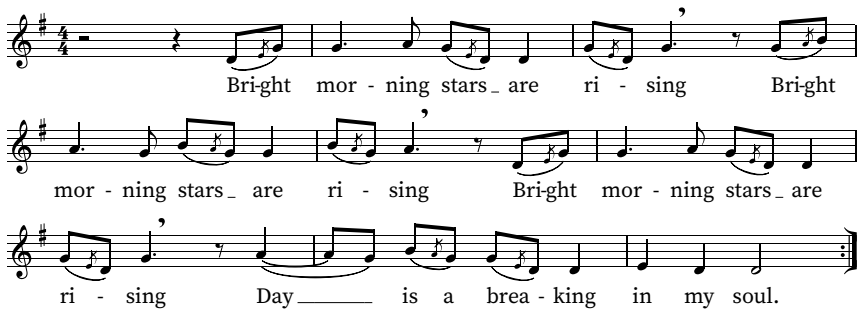
Celebrant. Will all of you witnessing these promises do all in your power to uphold these two persons in their marriage?

People. We will.

In a traditional Jewish wedding ceremony, the betrothed circle one another before entering the chuppah to be married. Claire and Eli will circle one another three times to honor that tradition.

Bright Morning Stars

Appalachian Traditional



Scripture

Celebrant. O gracious and everliving God: Look mercifully upon this man and this woman who come to you seeking your blessing, and assist them with your grace, that with true fidelity and steadfast love they may honor and keep the promises and vows they make; as you, the great provider, keep faith with us.

People. Amen.

Ruth, 1:15–17

(read by Amy Salvatore)

¹⁵ So Naomi said, “See, your sister-in-law has gone back to her people and to her gods; return after your sister-in-law.”

¹⁶ But Ruth said, “Do not press me to leave you or to turn back from following you! Where you go, I will go; where you stay, I will stay; your people shall be my people, and your God my God.

¹⁷ Where you die, I will die—there will I be buried. May the Lord do thus and so to me, and more as well, if even death parts me from you!”

REMARKS

The Rev. Brett R. Johnson

The Marriage

The couple exchanges vows.

Celebrant. Bless, O God, these rings, to be signs of the vows by which this man and this woman have bound themselves to one another.

People. Amen.

The couple exchanges rings.

Prayers for the Marriage

Celebrant. Eternal God, creator and preserver of all life, author of salvation, and giver of all grace: Look with favor upon the world you have made, and especially upon this man and this woman, whom you join in Holy Matrimony.

People. Amen.

Give them wisdom and devotion in the ordering of their common life, that each may be to the other a strength in need, a counselor in perplexity, a comfort in sorrow, and a companion in joy.

Amen.

Grant that their wills may be so knit together in your will, and their spirits in your Spirit, that they may grow in love and peace with you and one another all the days of their life.

Amen.

Give them grace, when they hurt each other, to recognize and acknowledge their fault, and to seek each other's forgiveness and yours.

Amen.

Make their life together a sign of your love to this lost and broken world, that unity may overcome estrangement, forgiveness heal guilt, and joy conquer despair.

Amen.

Bestow on them, if it is your will, the gift and heritage of children, and the grace to bring them up in your light.

Amen.

Give them such fulfillment of their mutual affection that they may reach out in love and concern for others.

Amen.

Grant that all married persons who have witnessed these vows may find their lives strengthened and their loyalties confirmed.

Amen.

Grant that the bonds of our common humanity, by which all your children are united one to another, and the living to the dead, may carry your grace into the world; in your name and all those we know you by.

Amen.

Seven Blessings on the Marriage

The Blessing of Abundance

(read by Emma Morrison)

from "To Autumn" by John Keats

Season of mists and mellow fruitfulness,

Close bosom-friend of the maturing sun;

Conspiring with him how to load and bless

With fruit the vines that round the thatch-eves run;

To bend with apples the moss'd cottage-trees,

And fill all fruit with ripeness to the core;

To swell the gourd, and plump the hazel shells

With a sweet kernel; to set budding more,

And still more, later flowers for the bees,

Until they think warm days will never cease,

For summer has o'er-brimm'd their clammy cells.

The Blessing of Creation (read by Lilah Drafts-Johnson)
from “Where Does the Temple Begin, Where Does it End?”
by Mary Oliver

The snake slides away; the fish jumps, like a little lily,
Out of the water and back in; the goldfinches sing
from the unreachable top of the tree.

I look; morning to night I am never done with looking.

Looking I mean not just standing around, but standing around
as though with your arms open.

The Blessing of Humanity (read by Adela DePavia)
from “An Invocation” by Seamus Heaney

Between the horizon and the dictionary,
Hard liner on the rock face of the old
Questions and answers, to which I add my own:
“Who is my neighbor? My neighbor is all mankind.”

The Blessing of Generations (read by Emilia Porubcin)
from “The Pomegranate and the Big Crowd” by Alberto Ríos

Everyone gathered, her friends and his. Everyone
Watched: the boys, the girls, the pigs and the chickens,
And more. Moving to the front were the children
She and Clemente would one day have,
And the children of those children, too,
Gathered and loud with everyone and everything else,
Loud as the pigs and fast as the chickens
Though she could not see them.

The Blessing of Community

(read by Jojo Amdur)

from “In the House with No Doors” by Sarah Kay

for a moment what you always hoped was true
finally is: loneliness has forgotten your address,
french toast browning on the stovetop,
the sound of everyone you love
clear as the sun giggling through the window,
not even a doorknob between you.

The Blessing of Companionship

(read by Monika O’Shea)

from “The Defeated” by Linda Gregg

Already what I remember
most is the happiness of seeing you. Having tea.
Falling asleep. Waking up with you there awake
in the kitchen. It was like being alive twice.

The Blessing of Celebration

(read by Rachel Fine)

from “The Undertaking” by Louise Glück

You are free. The river films with lilies,
shrubs appear, shoots thicken into palm. And now
all fear gives way: the light
looks after you, you feel the waves’ goodwill
as arms widen over the water; Love,
the key is turned. Extend yourself—
it is the Nile, the sun is shining,
everywhere you turn is luck.

The Pronouncement

Celebrant. Now that Claire and Eli have given themselves to each other through solemn vows, the joining of hands, the exchanging of rings, and the blessings of those that love them, in the Name of God, I pronounce that they are husband and wife.

Those whom God has joined together let no man put asunder.

People. Amen.

Recessional

John and Mary
Where's the Music?

*Jaco Pastorius
Medeski, Martin & Wood*

*As you depart, and as you are able, please help us by bringing your
chair to a table setting under the tent.*



Celebrant

The Rev. Brett R. Johnson
Emmanuel Episcopal Church
Wakefield, Massachusetts

Sound

Atticus Allen

Mandolin

Hanna Renedo

In loving memory of those who could not be with us today.

Erna Baum Joan Finn Louise Haldeman Michael Salvatore